

Flood Preparedness Guide

Understanding Floods

Floods are among the most common and widespread natural disasters, often caused by heavy rainfall, typhoons, overflowing rivers, storm surges, or dam failures. In the Philippines, floods are a frequent hazard due to the country's tropical climate and numerous water systems.

Flooding can result in loss of life, destruction of property, displacement of communities, and outbreaks of waterborne diseases. That's why understanding and preparing for floods is critical. This guide outlines steps to take before, during, and after a flood to help protect lives and reduce risks.

Before a Flood

- **Know if your area is prone to flooding.**
 - **Prepare an emergency kit** with food, water, medicine, and important documents.
 - **Keep important documents in waterproof containers.**
 - **Learn the safest route to high ground** from your home and workplace.
 - **Clear drains and gutters around your property.**
 - **Move valuable items and appliances to higher levels.**
 - **Ensure your family is familiar with your flood emergency plan.**
 - **Follow weather updates** from PAGASA and local authorities.
 - **Check and repair leaks** in roofs, walls, and foundations.
 - **Store drinking water in clean containers.**
 - **Prepare a “go bag”** in case of sudden evacuation.
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During a Flood

- **Move to higher ground immediately** if flooding occurs.
- **Do not walk, swim, or drive through floodwaters.**
- **Stay off bridges over fast-moving water.**
- **Disconnect electrical appliances** if safe to do so.
- **Follow evacuation orders promptly.**

- **If trapped, call for help** and move to the highest level of the building.
 - **Keep a battery-powered radio** for emergency updates.
 - **Keep your emergency kit close and accessible.**
 - **Wear sturdy clothing and footwear** to protect yourself.
 - **Avoid contact with floodwater** which may be contaminated.
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After a Flood

- **Return home only when authorities say it is safe.**
 - **Avoid floodwaters** as they may be contaminated.
 - **Do not use water that may be contaminated** for drinking, cooking, or cleaning.
 - **Discard food that has come into contact with floodwater.**
 - **Clean and disinfect everything that got wet.**
 - **Be aware of areas where floodwaters have receded** as roads may be weakened.
 - **Watch out for snakes, insects, or animals** driven into buildings by floodwater.
 - **Check your home for structural damage** before entering.
 - **Report downed power lines and gas leaks** to authorities.
 - **Keep children and pets away from hazardous areas.**
 - **Document damages** for insurance claims.
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Additional Resources

- **PAGASA:** <https://www.pagasa.dost.gov.ph>
- **NDRRMC:** <https://ndrrmc.gov.ph>
- **Philippine Red Cross:** <https://redcross.org.ph>
- Monitor your local government's announcements and social media pages.
- Join local disaster preparedness workshops when available.

Preparedness can save lives. Stay informed, stay ready, and stay safe.